

Know God's Inheritance for You

Revelation Becomes as Precious as Miracles

Begin in two places: Galatians 3 and John 8. We will review them for a few moments as we talk about our inheritance.

We have been seeing so many miracles lately: blind eyes, ears, and other things, especially in the last six months, and even more in the last three or four months since God began dealing with me about worship.

As I have watched these miracles, I have realized that I love the Word and I love the miracles. I used to think I loved miracles more than anything, seeing God put Himself on display like that. But now I am developing a deep-rooted love for revelation. I get as excited over a new revelation as I do seeing someone walk.

When revelation becomes part of your spirit, you realize the life in it. Through meditation, when I know I am about to uncover something, maybe something not even mentioned in our century, I get excited.

Learning to meditate is like exploring a new country. It is not new to God, but it may be new to us because it was lost in darkness.

Abraham's Covenant Resulted in Sonship, Not a Lesser Relationship

Early in the Born-Again Trail, we made the statement that the covenant God made with Abraham resulted in our sonship. Basically, we no longer have a covenant in the same sense; we are sons and daughters of God with an inheritance.

Of all the things taught on the Born-Again Trail, this may have been one of the hardest for people to get past: the covenant God cut with Abraham, "In thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed," resulted in sonship.

It is not the same as standing outside under covenant terms. We are literally sons and daughters of God.

Understanding adoption helped me. God asked me whether I would treat Daniel and Tawny, my adopted son and daughter, any differently from David, Bill, and Steve as far as inheritance is concerned.

I said, "No, I would not."

Then He asked what I would do if Daniel and Tawny brought out their adoption papers every time they wanted to ask me for something.

I said they would probably get the worst correction of their lives. Once the adoption process is complete, there is no difference. They are bone of my bone and flesh of my flesh.

David does not bring a binding agreement when he comes into the house and raids the refrigerator. He comes by inheritance and carries things off. Daniel and Tawny have the same rights. There is no difference.

The Spirit of Adoption Makes Us Heirs and Joint Heirs

The adoption that made us sons resulted from the covenant God made with Abraham. Romans 8 says:

"Ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear;
but ye have received the Spirit of adoption."

That spirit of bondage again to fear was the spiritually dead spirit inherited from Adam. The spirit of adoption is the human spirit adopted by God through the change of natures.

Then His Spirit bears witness with ours that we are the children of God. If children, then heirs: heirs of God and joint heirs with Christ.

In a Jewish family, the firstborn inherited the wealth of the father. Jesus is the Firstborn in our family, the oldest living Brother, the Firstborn among many brethren. He inherited all the Father had, and then made us joint heirs with Himself.

The next scheduled sovereign event in that joint heirship is the redemption of our bodies. Jesus rose from the dead and laid one glorified body to our account. I can believe for it all I want, but it will come when it comes. My part is to let the Holy Spirit seal me so the world will never claim me again.

Meanwhile, in my spirit, I have been quickened together with Christ and seated with Him in heavenly places. I have the rights of a son here in this earth, this outpost where I have been left as an ambassador for reconciliation.

Provision and the Pound Separate the Servant's Needs From the Master's Business

I like what Gary has been teaching on prosperity. We call this the Born-Again Trail; Gary calls his teaching on prosperity the rights of the inner man and his inheritance. In his vision, he saw a golden man, definitely different from the body, so he called it "the golden man."

He differentiated between provision and the pound. I had taught for years from the parable where the servant comes in from the field. The master does not sit the servant down first and feed him. The servant feeds the master, then eats from the master's table. Jesus said the master would not even thank him for doing what a servant is supposed to do.

Gary brought other parables into it, and that cleared up the in-between parts. Provision is what God promises the servant: he can sit at the master's table and his needs will be supplied. The pound belongs to God. The pound is what the master gave the servant and expected back with interest.

That is where greed gets crucified. Gary calculated his bills and found out what it took to get by. That was his provision. Everything over that was the pound God gave him for the Kingdom of God.

The way prosperity has often been preached is that ten percent is God's and ninety percent is ours. But Jesus said that when we have done all, we should say:

"We are unprofitable servants:
we have done that which was our duty to do."

In the Greek, the word is closer to slaves. We are doing what our calling requires.

Consecrated Provision Lets God Trust the Pound

When Gary consecrated the pound to God, unusual things began to happen. People who used to send twenties began sending hundreds. People who never sent anything began sending thousands. Investments he had forgotten about increased. Suddenly he was saying, "This is pound."

If a man is dead to greed, God can send a million dollars and know it will not simply bulge his pockets. It is pound.

Does God mind if your provision increases? Of course not. The Lord Jesus is an honest Master. He will treat you and your family well. But the question is whether He can trust you with the rest, because much of what comes in does not go to the Kingdom of God.

You may end up living better while giving far more. If your provision is twenty, thirty, forty, or fifty percent of what comes in, and the rest is pound, you may be giving half and still living better than when you gave God ten percent. The Lord Jesus will treat you fairly, but He is teaching us inheritance.

Sons Become Slaves by Love for the Father's Work

I am God's son, a joint heir with Jesus Christ. But the goal of my heart as His son is to go from minister of heavenly things, which is servant, to slave.

I want my Father to know that even though I am His son, I know I have a lot of family that is lost. In this part of my inheritance, my Father has asked me to join Him in seeking those who are lost in our family tree and bringing them home.

That is my goal in this life. In eternity, this may be the single most important thing He ever asks me to do, and I refuse to waste one moment of it.

Galatians Shows the Law as Schoolmaster Until Faith Came

Go to Galatians 3. Remember that the Galatians, like the Colossians, were attempting to go back under the law. Paul had come out from under the law, and he uses this whole letter to tell them, "You want to go back under bondage? Listen to me. I came out from under it."

Galatians 3:24 says:

"Wherefore the law was our schoolmaster
to bring us unto Christ,
that we might be justified by faith."

The law was a schoolmaster in two ways. First, its shadows and types pointed to Christ. Second, it revealed to spiritually dead men the nature they had. Being born spiritually dead, they did not know they were spiritually dead. When the law said, "Thou shalt not covet," and they tried to stop coveting, they found they could not. The law schooled them in their need for a Redeemer.

Paul continues:

"But after that faith is come,
we are no longer under a schoolmaster.
For ye are all the children of God
by faith in Christ Jesus."

Then he says:

"If ye be Christ's,
then are ye Abraham's seed,
and heirs according to the promise."

If you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham's seed and an heir according to the promise.

The Natural Heir Under Law Was Still No Different From a Slave

Galatians 4:1 says:

"Now I say,
That the heir,
as long as he is a child,
differeth nothing from a servant,
though he be lord of all."

Paul is addressing the law. The Jew was a natural heir to the promise of Abraham, yet under the law he differed nothing from a slave because he was spiritually dead. He was under tutors and governors until the time appointed of the Father.

When the fullness of time came, God sent forth His Son, made of a woman, made under the law, to redeem those under the law so that they might receive the adoption of sons.

Jesus was born spiritually alive. He was the first man in four thousand years qualified to keep the law. He fulfilled it, became a curse for those under it, and freed them so they also could receive adoption.

Because we are now sons, God sent forth the Spirit of His Son into our hearts, crying, "Abba, Father." We are no more slaves, but sons; and if sons, then heirs of God through Christ.

Returning to Days and Seasons Is Returning to Beggarly Elements

Paul says:

"But now, after that ye have known God,
or rather are known of God,
how turn ye again to the weak and beggarly elements,
whereunto ye desire again to be in bondage?
Ye observe days, and months, and times, and years."

When I went to Israel, I sat at a table with Christian believers who were keeping the Sabbath and several feast days. I wanted to be civil, but when one woman said, "I just feel more complete," I could not hold my tongue.

I started with the Sabbath. The Sabbath was a type of being born again. That is why they could not work on the Sabbath. They could not even pick up sticks for firewood without judgment, because salvation is not by works, lest any man should boast. The man picking up sticks was saying, in type, "I can be saved by my works." You cannot.

The Sabbath is perpetual because in the new birth it became perpetual. Jesus is Lord of the Sabbath every day. He is Lord of my rebirth. I live in that rest. I went to inheritance and quit working for sonship.

Deception Builds When the Holy Spirit Is Not Allowed to Teach

That deceptive spirit is in the earth today. It gets people fifteen or twenty degrees off, and they feel holy when they turn out the lights and lock themselves up.

Years ago, in Brazil, a woman with a national ministry came to some meetings. One day I saw a vision of Satan standing in front of her, buffeting her and destroying her reasonings. I wept and warned her. She said she was aware of his devices.

I told her, "When he comes, he never comes as himself. His strength is in you not recognizing him."

About two years later, she began keeping the Sabbath and other holy days and preaching other things. When a person gets off two or three degrees, deception becomes a foundation for more deception, just as revelation becomes a foundation for more revelation.

But as a son, you have a Teacher. God sent Him to seal your inheritance. He is the Enforcer. As Lawyer, He argues your rights in your spirit every time you pray in tongues. He will make sure deception is aborted if you trust the praying and keep doing it no matter what your emotions say.

If the Holy Spirit is your Teacher, even the smallest dart of error through your spirit makes you say, "This is not right." That explains how someone can teach wonderful revelation one day and then teach something foolish and contrary to the nature of the Father the next. If the Holy Spirit is not his Teacher, his intellect is his teacher, and then he is at the mercy of reasoning.

Shepherds Must Not Feed Sticks to People Who Trust Them

People sometimes say, "When I sit under someone, I just spit out the sticks." That may sound spiritual, but what am I paying a shepherd for if I have to guard against what he is telling me?

If people are working twelve or fourteen hours a day, sending their children to someone else to watch, trying to keep up with creature comforts, and then this man is pastoring them, he had better not put sticks in the message. They do not have time to do what he does. What did they buy him a car for?

He may teach ten good messages and destroy a life with the eleventh. Thank God for our Teacher, the earnest of our inheritance, the seal unto the redemption of the purchased possession: spirit, soul, body, glorified body, and full inheritance.

If you get to know Him well here, that is all you will live for. Even the throne He sets you on becomes relevant only because it means being closer to Him.

Colossians Says the Shadow Ended When the Body Came

Colossians 2:15-17 says:

"Having spoiled principalities and powers,
he made a shew of them openly,
triumphing over them in it.
Let no man therefore judge you in meat,
or in drink,
or in respect of an holyday,
or of the new moon,
or of the sabbath days:
which are a shadow of things to come;
but the body is of Christ."

Let no man judge you in food, drink, holy days, new moons, harvest days, or Sabbaths. These were shadows of things to come, but the body making the shadow is Christ.

You cannot stand in the shadow and in the body making the shadow at the same time. Israel served the shadow through the tabernacle, sacrifices, feast days, Sabbaths, holy days, and offerings. As long as there was a shadow, it testified that something real was coming. When the body came, the shadow was no longer the place to live.

I have been born again. I will not be judged by Sabbaths, harvest days, new moons, wave offerings, or drink offerings. I am in Christ.

John 8 Locates Freedom in Sonship

Go to John 8:29:

"And he that sent me is with me:
the Father hath not left me alone;
for I do always those things that please him."

As He spoke these words, many believed on Him. Then Jesus said to those Jews who believed:

"If ye continue in my word,
then are ye my disciples indeed;
and ye shall know the truth,
and the truth shall make you free."

We often use that verse for every aspect of redemption. If we continue in the Word about healing, prosperity, or any truth, we know the truth and it makes us free. That is a true fruit of the verse, but in context Jesus is talking to Jews, especially Pharisees, about the freedom of sonship.

They answered:

"We be Abraham's seed,
and were never in bondage to any man:
how sayest thou,
Ye shall be made free?"

Jesus answered:

"Whosoever committeth sin
is the servant of sin.
And the servant abideth not in the house for ever:
but the Son abideth ever.
If the Son therefore shall make you free,
ye shall be free indeed."

They were Abraham's seed, but whoever commits sin is a slave to sin. The heir under law was no different from a slave while under tutors and governors. Jesus came, born of a woman and born under the law, to free those under the law so they could receive the adoption of sons.

The slave does not abide in the house forever. The Son abides forever. If the Son makes you free, you are free indeed.

The Holy Spirit Teaches Sons to Live From Their Inheritance

You are free. You are a son. You have an inheritance. The Father wants to pour that inheritance out on you, especially to do the work that must be done in the earth.

He does not mind increasing your provision. The table may become better and better. But the servant says, "The field You gave me to work is the most important thing right now. Here is the pound."

You must take the Holy Spirit as your Teacher. He is the only One who can keep your reasonings from being destroyed and keep you from creating religion while passing by the power of God. He is your Administrator, your earnest, and your Teacher.

Let Him teach you who you are until you believe enough to do something in this earth. Do not live under present bondage. Get bondage out of your body, your finances, and your life.

You are a son of God.